

Lesson 4: Creating Checkboxes

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What We'll Learn

By the end of this lesson, students can:

- Create checkboxes using `<input type="checkbox">`.
- Connect checkboxes with their labels.
- Use the `name` and `value` attributes correctly.
- Create a form that allows multiple selections.

Before We Start

Imagine that a school form asks you to select the clubs you want to join.

Can you select more than one club?

Checkboxes are useful when users are allowed to choose one, several, or none of the available options.

Let's Understand

A checkbox is created using an `<input>` element with `type="checkbox"`.

```
<input type="checkbox">
```

A label should be added so users know what the checkbox represents.

```
<input type="checkbox" id="coding">  
<label for="coding">Coding Club</label>
```

The `for` attribute of the `<label>` must match the `id` of the checkbox.

Using the Name and Value Attributes

The `name` attribute identifies the group of information being collected.

The `value` attribute identifies the selected option.

```
<input  
  type="checkbox"  
  id="coding"  
  name="club"  
  value="Coding Club"  
>  
<label for="coding">Coding Club</label>
```

If several checkboxes belong to the same question, they can use the same `name` but must have different `id` and `value` attributes.

```
<input  
  type="checkbox"  
  id="coding"  
  name="club"  
  value="Coding Club"  
>  
<label for="coding">Coding Club</label>  
  
<input  
  type="checkbox"  
  id="arts"  
  name="club"  
  value="Arts Club"  
>  
<label for="arts">Arts Club</label>
```

The user can select both clubs because checkboxes allow multiple selections.

Creating a Preselected Checkbox

The checked attribute makes a checkbox selected when the page first opens.

```
<input
  type="checkbox"
  id="updates"
  name="updates"
  value="yes"
  checked
>
<label for="updates">Receive school updates</label>
```

Users can still clear the checkbox if they do not want the option.

Let's Practice

Create checkboxes for the following school activities:

- Basketball
- Volleyball
- Badminton

Each checkbox must have:

- A unique id
- A matching <label>
- The same name
- A different value

Let's Look at Examples

Example 1: Single Checkbox

This example asks the student whether they want to receive school announcements.

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
  <meta charset="UTF-8">
  <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
  <title>School Announcements</title>
</head>
<body>
  <h1>School Announcements</h1>

  <form>
    <input
      type="checkbox"
      id="announcements"
      name="announcements"
      value="yes"
    >
    <label for="announcements">
      Send me school announcements
    </label>
  </form>
</body>
</html>
```

The checkbox lets the student choose whether they want to receive school announcements.

Common mistake

Students may forget to connect the label to the checkbox. The label's for attribute must match the checkbox's id.

Example 2: Selecting Favorite Subjects

This example allows the student to select more than one favorite subject.

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
  <meta charset="UTF-8">
  <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
  <title>Favorite Subjects</title>
</head>
<body>
  <h1>Select Your Favorite Subjects</h1>

  <form>
    <p>You may select more than one subject.</p>

    <p>
      <input
        type="checkbox"
        id="mathematics"
        name="favoriteSubject"
        value="Mathematics"
      >
      <label for="mathematics">Mathematics</label>
    </p>

    <p>
      <input
        type="checkbox"
        id="science"
        name="favoriteSubject"
        value="Science"
      >
      <label for="science">Science</label>
    </p>

    <p>
      <input
        type="checkbox"
        id="english"
        name="favoriteSubject"
        value="English"
      >
      <label for="english">English</label>
    </p>

    <p>
      <input
        type="checkbox"
        id="computer"
        name="favoriteSubject"
        value="Computer"
      >
```

```
        >
        <label for="computer">Computer</label>
    </p>
</form>
</body>
</html>
```

All checkboxes use the same name because they answer the same question. Each checkbox has a unique id and value.

Common mistake

Students may give every checkbox the same id. Each id must be unique so every label connects to the correct checkbox.

Example 3: Student Interest Form

This example combines text, email, password, and checkbox inputs.

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
  <meta charset="UTF-8">
  <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
  <title>Student Interest Form</title>
</head>
<body>
  <h1>Student Interest Form</h1>

  <form>
    <p>
      <label for="student-name">Student Name:</label>
      <input
        type="text"
        id="student-name"
        name="studentName"
      >
    </p>

    <p>
      <label for="student-email">Email Address:</label>
      <input
        type="email"
        id="student-email"
        name="studentEmail"
      >
    </p>

    <p>
      <label for="student-password">Password:</label>
      <input
        type="password"
        id="student-password"
        name="studentPassword"
      >
    </p>

    <h2>Select Your Interests</h2>

    <p>
      <input
        type="checkbox"
        id="web-design"
        name="interest"
        value="Web Design"
      >
      <label for="web-design">Web Design</label>
    </p>
```

```

<p>
  <input
    type="checkbox"
    id="programming"
    name="interest"
    value="Programming"
  >
  <label for="programming">Programming</label>
</p>

<p>
  <input
    type="checkbox"
    id="digital-art"
    name="interest"
    value="Digital Art"
  >
  <label for="digital-art">Digital Art</label>
</p>

<p>
  <input
    type="checkbox"
    id="updates"
    name="updates"
    value="yes"
    checked
  >
  <label for="updates">
    Receive information about upcoming activities
  </label>
</p>
</form>
</body>
</html>

```

The interest checkboxes use the same name because they belong to one group. The announcements checkbox uses a different name because it collects different information.

Common mistake

Students may forget the value attribute. Without it, the selected checkbox may not clearly identify which option the user chose.